

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 5
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K 9 3
♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ K 10 2
♥ K Q 9 8 2
♦ 8 5 4
♣ A 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 6 3
♥ 7
♦ Q J 10 6
♣ J 10 7 2

♠ Q 9 4
♥ A J 6 3
♦ A 7 2
♣ K 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			

4 ♥ by North

to play a ♠ (or give you a ruff-sluff). And as long as they start the ♠s you are assured that you will lose only one ♠ trick, the ♠ A.

Assume East is on lead for the first ♠ play.

If he leads the ♠ A it sets up both the ♠ K and ♠ Q so you only have one ♠ loser. If he leads low you also play low from dummy and West must play the ♠ J to prevent you getting a trick with the ♠ 10. Again you only lose one ♠.

If West makes the first play by leading a low ♠ you play low from your hand. East must go up with the ♠ A to stop you from getting a trick with dummy's ♠ 9. Then your ♠ K and ♠ Q will win two tricks.

North is to play 4 ♥. East leads the ♦ Q.

You have two ♦ losers that you can't escape, as well as the ♠ A. So you must arrange your play so you don't lose a trick to the ♠ J. That could mean you will finesse one defender for that card, but it would be a lot better if you could make the defense play ♠s first.

There is no reason to hold up so take your ♦ A and pull trumps, West showing up with three of them.

Now eliminate ♣s by playing ♣ A, ♣ K, and ruffing a ♣.

The stage is now set for the throw-in. Be **SURE** to lead a ♦ for the throw-in, not a ♠.

The defense will win the ♦ and can then take another ♦ trick if they like. But then they will have

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5
 ♥ K Q J 10 8 4
 ♦ -
 ♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3

West	North	East	South
1♥	2♥	Pass	1♦
All Pass		Dbl	6♦

6♦ by South

You want to play the first ♣ from dummy, so enter dummy with a trump.

Play the ♣10 from dummy and let it ride if East does not produce the ♣Q or ♣K. West will win with one of the honors but will have to return another ♣ or give you a ruff-sluff.

When you are missing the K Q of a suit, as in the ♣s on this hand, taking two finesses gives you a 75% chance of success - **all things being equal**.

In this case though, West's overcall means all things are not equal, so your chances are lower than 75%.

But never mind the percentages for a finesse, the end-play was a sure thing.

North's 2♥ bid showed a hand with limit raise or better in ♦s. South doesn't bother with Blackwood since he already knows about the Aces. He just bids the slam. South plays 6♦. West leads the ♥K, won by you with the ♥A.

The good news is that you have no losers in ♠s, ♥, or ♦s. The bad news is that you have two losers in ♣s. The good news is that missing the ♣K Q you could try two finesses. The bad news is that West overcalled, so he probably has both honors. The best news of all is that you know how to pull off an elimination play!. Play a trump to dummy's ♦K (West discards a ♥) and ruff the ♥5.

Pull the outstanding trump with the ♦A, then play ♠A, ♠K and ruff a ♠.